VJTI Mumbai: Anti-Ragging & Grievance Redressal Policy

VJTI Mumbai maintains a zero-tolerance policy towards ragging and has established a robust mechanism to address student grievances, strictly following the **Maharashtra Prohibition of Ragging Act (1999)** and **UGC/AICTE Regulations**.

1. Official Definition of Ragging

As per the *Maharashtra Prohibition of Ragging Act* and *UGC Guidelines*, ragging is defined as:

"Any conduct whether by words spoken or written or by an act which has the effect of teasing, treating or handling with rudeness any other student, indulging in rowdy or undisciplined activities which causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship or psychological harm or to raise fear or apprehension thereof in a fresher or a junior student."

Commonly Identified Acts of Ragging:

- **Physical Abuse:** Pushing, hitting, or forcing physical exertion.
- **Psychological Harm:** Verbal abuse, public insults, or making a student perform acts that cause embarrassment.
- **Economic Dimension:** Forceful extortion of money or forcing a student to pay for a senior's expenses.
- **Academic Slavery:** Forcing a junior to complete a senior's assignments, journals, or errands.

2. Step-by-Step Incident Reporting Process

If you are a victim or a witness to ragging, follow this formal escalation ladder to ensure immediate action:

Step 1: Immediate Informal Reporting (Optional but Fast)

Contact your **Hostel Warden** (if the incident is in the hostel) or any **Faculty Member** you trust. They are mandated to protect your identity and escort you to the committee.

Step 2: Formal Written Complaint

Submit a written complaint (signed or anonymous) to the **Anti-Ragging Committee**.

- **Where to submit:** Drop it in the "Grievance Box" located in the Main Building or hand it over directly to the **Faculty In-charge of Student Activities** (Dr. Suranjana Gangopadhyay).
- **Include:** Date, time, location, names of the perpetrators, and a brief description of the incident.

Step 3: Filing an Online Complaint (National Level)

It is highly recommended to register the complaint on the **UGC National Anti-Ragging Portal** to ensure the college is held accountable.

1. Visit www.antiragging.in.
2. Fill out the "Register Complaint" form with VJTI's details.
3. An automated email will be sent to the VJTI Director and the local police station immediately.

Step 4: Committee Enquiry

The **Anti-Ragging Squad** (a smaller mobile unit) will conduct a surprise raid or a secret enquiry. Within **24–48 hours**, the main committee will summon the accused for a hearing.

3. Punishment for Ragging

The following penalties are mandatory upon conviction:

- **Suspension:** From classes or the hostel.
- **Rustication:** Immediate expulsion from the institute for 1 to 4 semesters.
- **Legal Action:** Under the Maharashtra Act, ragging is a **cognizable offense**. An FIR will be filed, leading to up to **2 years of imprisonment** and a fine of up to **₹10,000**.
- **Blacklisting:** Convicted students are debarred from admission to any other educational institution for **5 years**.

4. Emergency Contact Directory

Authority	Contact Person / Platform	Phone / Email
National Helpline	UGC 24x7 Toll-Free	**1800-180-5522**
Director, VJTI	Dr. Sachin D. Kore	director@vjti.ac.in
Faculty In-charge	Dr. S. Gangopadhyay	sgangopadhyay@tx.vjti.ac.in
Matunga Police	Nearest Station	022-24143333

Safe Campus Tip: *Every student at VJTI must submit an Online Anti-Ragging Affidavit at the start of every academic year. Ensure you have your "Reference Number" saved; it is mandatory for hostel and exam registration.*